सत्यमेव जयते

F No. 9/35/2026-CD(Cen)
भारत सरकार/Government of India
गृह मंत्रालय/Ministry of Home Affairs
भारत के महारजिस्ट्रार एवं जनगणना आयुक्त का कार्यालय
Office of the Registrar General & Census Commissioner, India
जनगणना भवन, टावर-ए, 2-ए,मान सिंह रोड,नई दिल्ली-110011
Janganana Bhawan, Tower-A, 2/A, Man Singh Road,
New Delhi-110011.

Dated: 09.01.2026

CENSUS OF INDIA 2027 – CIRCULAR NO. 8

Subject: Assigning Location/Short Code numbers at various administrative levels.

The Location Code is a simple and unique number by which every area in any administrative unit in the State/Union Territory can be identified. Assigning Location Code is necessary not only to facilitate unambiguous and complete coverage of the area of the State/Union Territory but also to serve as the key identifying factor at the time of data processing. Assigning Location Codes to each administrative unit in the country is thus one of the important steps in the conduct of Census.

2. The Location Codes are assigned to all the administrative units right from State/ Union Territory to the lowest level, namely Houselisting Block (HLB)/Enumeration Block (EB). Thus, Location Code(s) will be assigned to each State/ Union Territory followed by District, Sub-District (i.e. Tahsil, Taluk, Circle, Development Block or Mandal, etc.) and Village/Towns. Within each town, Location Code will be assigned to each Ward. For the purpose of conducting Census, each Village or Ward (in Towns) will further be divided into HLBs/ EBs, and a Location Code will have to be assigned to each of these HLBs/EBs.

3. Circulars 1 and 2 for Census 2027 regarding jurisdictional changes in each State/ Union Territory and preparation of Rural-Urban frames have already been issued. The complete and up-to-date list of Districts, Sub-districts, Villages, Towns and Wards (in Towns) should have already been compiled by now. In addition, demarcation of Rural and Urban areas by identifying Census Town and Outgrowths (OGs) should also been

done at each Directorate. The purpose of this circular is to detail the methodology of assigning short codes to each of these administrative units.

4. In the last Census 2011, administrative units within the State/District/Sub-District were given continuous location codes (short codes) for convenience during field operation. For Census 2027, short codes will be assigned to each administrative unit on Jurisdictional Changes (JC) Portal.

5. The coding sequence of Short Codes for the purpose of field work will be:

Sr No	Administrative unit	Coding structure	Remarks
1	State/UT	2 digits	Unique within country
2	Districts	2 digits	Unique within state
3	Sub-Districts	3 digits	Unique within district
4	Villages	4 digits (starting from 0001)	Unique within sub-district
5	Forest Villages	4 digits (starting from 6001)	Unique within sub-district
6	Statutory Towns	4 digits (starting from 7001)	Unique within state
7	Census towns	4 digits (starting from 8001)	Unique within state
8	Wards	4 digits (starting from 0001)	Unique within Town

6. All the DCOs are updating jurisdictional changes on the jurisdiction changes portal (https://jurisdiction.census.gov.in/login) developed in-house. Short code of all administrative units (State/UT/District/Sub-district/Town/Village) will be generated through this portal. The mechanism for generation of these codes will be:

- Location codes used in 2011 Census for the administrative units will be the base codes for Census 2027.

- New administrative unit(s) created from the parent will get incremental code. The other units in the hierarchy will get next incremental codes.
- In case of merging, the code of the parent unit in which the other unit gets merged will remain same and other units in the hierarchy will get next incremental codes.

The detailed methodology for assigning short codes to the State/UT/District/Sub-District/Town/Village is elaborated below.

A. Assigning Short Codes to States/Union Territories

i) In Census 2011, Location Codes have been assigned to the States/Union Territories by the Office of the Registrar General and Census Commissioner, India based on their geographical location beginning from Jammu & Kashmir (01) in the North-West down to Andaman and Nicobar Islands (35) in the South-East. These Codes were of two-digit, unique within the country.

ii) In Census 2027, for the new State/UT created after 2011, the parent State from where new State/UT has been carved out due to addition/deletion of area will retain the same short code as of 2011 and the newly created State/UT will get next incremental code. The codes for subsequent States/UTs will be shifted accordingly, as illustrated below.

State/Union Territory	Location Short Code in Census 2011	Location Short Code in Census 2027	Remarks
1	2	3	4
Jammu & Kashmir	01	01	New UTs Ladakh & J & K carved out from J & K State
Ladakh	Formed after 2011	02	
Himachal Pradesh	02	03	
Punjab	03	04	
Chandigarh	04	05	

State/Union Territory	Location Short Code in Census 2011	Location Short Code in Census 2027	Remarks
1	2	3	4
Uttarakhand	05	06	
Haryana	06	07	
Delhi	07	08	
Rajasthan	08	09	
Uttar Pradesh	09	10	
Bihar	10	11	
Sikkim	11	12	
Arunachal Pradesh	12	13	
Nagaland	13	14	
Manipur	14	15	
Mizoram	15	16	
Tripura	16	17	
Meghalaya	17	18	
Assam	18	19	
West Bengal	19	20	
Jharkhand	20	21	
Odisha	21	22	
Chhattisgarh	22	23	
Madhya Pradesh	23	24	
Gujarat	24	25	
Daman & Diu	25	Merged after 2011	Daman & Diu UT (25) merged in Dadra and Nagar Haveli UT (26)

State/Union Territory	Location Short Code in Census 2011	Location Short Code in Census 2027	Remarks
1	2	3	4
Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu	26	26	
Maharashtra	27	27	
Andhra Pradesh	28	28	New State Telangana carved out from Andhra Pradesh
Telangana	Formed after 2011	29	
Karnataka	29	30	
Goa	30	31	
Lakshadweep	31	32	
Kerala	32	33	
Tamil Nadu	33	34	
Puducherry	34	35	
Andaman & Nicobar Islands	35	36	

B. Assigning Short Codes to Districts

The short code for parent district(s) will remain same and the newly created district(s) will get the next incremental code. The codes for subsequent districts will be shifted accordingly.

For example, there were 26 districts in Gujarat as per Census 2011. 8 new districts have been created after 2011. These new districts will get code next to the parent district from which they have created.

Census 2011		Census 2027		Remarks
Name of the district	Short codes	Name of the district	Short codes	
1	2	3	4	5
Kachchh	01	Kachchh	01	
Banas Kantha	02	Banas Kantha	02	
		Vav-Tharad	03	New District Vav-Tharad carved out from Banas kantha
Patan	03	Patan	04	
Mahesana	04	Mahesana	05	
Sabar Kantha	05	Sabar Kantha	06	
		Arvalli	07	New District Arvalli carved out from Sabarkantha
Gandhinagar	06	Gandhinagar	08	
Ahmedabad	07	Ahmedabad	09	
		Botad	10	New District Botad carved out from Ahmedabad & Bhavnagar
Surendranagar	08	Surendranagar	11	
		Morbi	12	New District Morbi carved out from Surendranagar, Rajkot, Jamnagar
Rajkot	09	Rajkot	13	
Jamnagar	10	Jamnagar	14	
		Devbhumi Dwarka	15	New District Devbhumi Dwarka carved out from Jamnagar
Porbandar	11	Porbandar	16	
Junagadh	12	Junagadh	17	
		Gir Somnath	18	New District Gir Somnath carved out from Junagadh

Census 2011		Census 2027		Remarks
Name of the district	Short codes	Name of the district	Short codes	
1	2	3	4	5
Amreli	13	Amreli	19	
Bhavnagar	14	Bhavnagar	20	
Anand	15	Anand	21	
Kheda	16	Kheda	22	
		Mahisagar	23	New District Mahisagar carved out from Kheda & Panch Mahals
Panch Mahals	17	Panch Mahals	24	
Dohad	18	Dahod	25	
Vadodara	19	Vadodara	26	
		Chhotaudepur	27	New District Chhotaudepur carved out from Vadodara
Narmada	20	Narmada	28	
Bharuch	21	Bharuch	29	
The Dangs	22	The Dangs	30	
Navsari	23	Navsari	31	
Valsad	24	Valsad	32	
Surat	25	Surat	33	
Tapi	26	Tapi	34	

c. **Assigning Short Codes to Sub-Districts (Tahsil/Taluk/Circle/Development Block/Mandal etc.)**

i) The Sub-Districts in different States/UTs are known by different names such as Tahsil, Taluk, Mandal etc. Newly created subdistricts will get next incremental code of the parent sub district from which it is created.

ii) For example, there were 6 sub districts in Jhunjhunun district of Rajasthan in

which 6 new sub districts are created and 5 sub districts are created in newly created district Salumbar of Rajasthan state. The method of assigning sub-district codes for Census 2027 is shown below:

Census 2011		Census 2027		Remarks
District- Jhunjhunun		District- Jhunjhunun		
Name of Sub-District	Short Code	Name of Sub-District	Short Code	
Jhunjhunun	001	Jhunjhunun	001	
		Malsisar	002	New sub dist Malsisar carved out from Jhunjhunun
		Mandawa	003	New sub dist Mandawa carved out from Jhunjhunun, Malsisar
		Bissau	004	New sub dist Bissau carved out from Malsisar, Mandawa
Chirawa	002	Chirawa	005	
		Surajgarh	006	New sub dist Surajgarh carved out from Chirawa
		Pilani	007	New sub dist Pilani carved out from Surajgarh
Buhana	003	Buhana	008	
Khetri	004	Khetri	009	
Nawalgarh	005	Nawalgarh	010	
Udaipurwati	006	Udaipurwati	011	
		Gudhagorji	012	New sub dist Gudhagorji carved out from Udaipurwati

Census 2011		Census 2027		Remarks
District- Udaipur		New District - Salumber		
Name of Sub-District	Short Code	Name of Sub-District	Short Code	
Lasadiya	007	Lasadiya	001	
Salumbar	008	Salumbar	002	
		Jhallara	003	New sub dist Jhallara carved out from Salumbar
Sarada	009	Sarada	004	
		Semari	005	New sub dist Semari carved out from Sarada

D. **Assigning Short Codes to Statutory Towns**

i) Local Bodies notified as Towns by the State Governments under the Nagar Palika Act or any other statute like the Cantonments Act, Cantonment Board Act etc. are called Statutory Towns. Municipal Corporations, Municipalities, Townships, Cantonment Boards, Notified Area Councils etc. are examples of Statutory Towns.

ii) For the purpose of assigning location codes for Census 2027 to the newly created Statutory towns, next incremental code of the parent town from which it is created will be assigned., The structure of codes will remain same as mentioned in table in para 5. Each of the Statutory Towns would be assigned a 4-digit code within a range of 7001-7999, i.e., unique within the State.

E. **Assigning Short Code to Census Towns**

i) Census Towns are areas that are not defined as Towns by State Governments but have urban characteristics (a minimum population of 5,000, at least 75% of the male main working population in the town engaged in non-agricultural activities and a population density of at least 400 persons per square kilometer).

ii) For the purpose of assigning location codes for Census 2027, incremental

code will be given to newly classified census town and codes for subsequent census towns will be shifted accordingly. Each of the Census Towns would be assigned a 4-digit code within a range of 8001-8999, i.e. unique within the State.

iii) It is to be noted that all the Census Towns of Census 2011, which have been declassified as a Census Town would have to be treated as a Village in Census 2027 and will be allotted its Village Short Code. The procedure for assigning a new Village Short Code is discussed later in this circular.

F. Assigning Ward Codes

i) The Statutory Towns and Cantonment Boards are further divided into Wards. These wards are assigned distinct numbers in continuous series for the entire Town by competent authority and are notified. The Ward Short Code number will be a four-digit code for each notified ward unique within the Town. The four digits would denote the serial number of the ward as notified within the Town by the competent authority. Thus, the code number for first ward within a Town would begin at '0001', and will continue as '0002', 0003 ....so on, i.e. afresh. Entire Census Town will be considered as having only one Ward and would carry Ward code '0001'.

ii) An Out Growth (OG) is an urban settlement contiguous to another urban area like Statutory Town. Though it possesses all the urban characteristics, it is not qualified as an independent town. An OG shall be assigned the next incremental number following the last ward code of the town. In case there is more than one OG, they shall be assigned successive incremental codes.

iii) If possible, Ward Name shall also be provided against the Ward Code to identify the OGs, etc.

iv) Since, jurisdiction portal is not having provision to enter wards, ward codes to be assigned by DCOs as explained in above.

G. Assigning Short Code to Villages

i) For the purpose of Census, a Village denotes a revenue Village and, not a Village Panchayat or a Hamlet of a Village. Every Revenue Village has already been allotted 4-digit Short Code in Census 2011, unique within sub-district. If there is no change in the number of villages of a Sub-District in 2027 then the same

Village Code shall be retained for Census 2027 also. Otherwise fresh short codes (0001 to 5999) within the Sub-District shall be given to the Villages as given in Census 2011. The mechanism for assigning short code to new village will be same as for other units i.e. newly created village will get incremental code of the parent village from which they are created. In case of villages split from statutory towns, the short codes will be assigned - as incremental number of last village short code within sub-district.

ii) **Jhoom Villages:** In the North Eastern States of the country, Jhoom cultivation may still be practiced. Village settlement shifts from one place to other due to this practice. It has been observed that some time the names of such Villages also change at the new settlement site. As cadastral surveys may not have been completed in such States, the revenue boundaries of Villages are not fixed. Such shifting settlements which are not of permanent nature should be treated as new Villages and accordingly Village Code numbers will be assigned. (4-digit short code ranging 0001-5999)

iii) **Forest Villages:** There are number of settlements in forest areas. Some of these settlements are of a permanent nature and are entered in the revenue records, whereas some settlements are purely temporary and under the control of Forest Department. At the time of Census, list of such settlements/Villages are obtained from the Forest Department and separate Village Short Code numbers are allotted to them. In order to distinguish the Forest Villages from the Revenue Villages, in Census 2027, 4-digit short code ranging 6001-6999 will be allotted to all the Forest Villages as done in Census 2011 within sub-district. If there is no change in the number of Forest Villages of a Sub-District in 2027 then the same Village Code shall be retained for Census 2027 also. Otherwise, mechanism as mentioned above will be adopted.

7. In 2027 to distinguish each type of Administrative unit clearly, short codes in the following ranges will be used.

Normal Villages	0001-5999
Forest Villages	6001-6999

Statutory Towns	7001-7999
Census Towns	8001-8999

8. The provision of New/Split or merger cases shall be as follows for Districts/Sub-districts/Towns/Villages:

New/Split cases: In case of creation of new District/Sub-district/Town/Village, the new entity will get the incremental code of the parent entity from which it is created irrespective of the geographical location.

Merger cases: In case of merger, the short code of the parent entity in which the entity is merged will remain intact and subsequent entities will get incremental codes.

9. **Assigning Houselisting Block Number**

i) Each Villages and Town will comprise of one or more Houselisting Blocks (HLBs) / Enumeration Blocks (EBs). All such HLBs/EBs within a charge- whether rural or urban-will bear a continuous serial number. It is important to remember that HLBs/EBs will be numbered continuously within each charge, like 0001, 0002.... 9999, etc. If a City or a Town contains more than one Charge, the HLBs/EBs would have to be formed charge wise and numbered continuously within each Charge start from 0001.

ii) It is likely that smaller Villages will be constituted into single HLB/EB while large Villages will have to be divided into two or more HLBs/EBs. All Villages in a charge would have to be arranged in ascending order of the Short Code and HLBs/EBs numbered continuously beginning from the first Village in that Sub-District.

10. It is important to note that the jurisdiction of every administrative unit right from first unit i.e. State/ Union Territory up to the last level i.e. Houselisting Block(HLB)/Enumeration Block(EB) is clearly indicated and identified by every Census Officer having jurisdiction over the area. It is pertinent to note that when particular Revenue Village is referred to, it denotes not merely the residential (or

Basti) area, but the entire revenue limit of the Village as demarcated in the land records. Similarly, in the case of City/ Town, the jurisdiction will be as notified by the State Government/ Union Territory Administration. If specific area has been excluded from the jurisdiction of a City/ Town or when only part(s) of a Village have been included within the limits of a City/ Town, such excluded areas or the remaining parts of such Villages will have to be included in the adjoining Rural Charge of which they form part of, even if such excluded areas of the Village are uninhabited. Accordingly, such areas will be allotted appropriate Village Short Code numbers in concerned Rural Charge.

11. **All DCOs will be provided with a list of all administrative units (District/Sub-District/Town/Village) as on 01.01.2026 along with short codes in the format given in the Annexure. Since the short codes will be generated through the Jurisdiction portal, there is a possibility that these units may not follow the exact geographic sequence from north-west to south-east. Further, if short codes used in 2011 were not assigned according to geographical locations as intended, this may result in the Jurisdictional Portal not following the same sequence of short codes when generating from them for Census 2027. Consequently, if any DCOs want to update the short codes as required for the smooth functionality of data collection for their charges, DCOs can modify the short codes manually for each administrative units and fill them in columns 5, 8 and 11 of the format as given in Annexure 1 and Annexure 2, for rural and urban areas respectively, separately for district, sub district and villages/towns. DCOs who intend to use the short codes as generated from the Jurisdictional portal are requested to copy all such codes from the respective column generated in the Jurisdiction portal i.e. columns 4, 7 and 10 and paste them in columns 5,8 and 11 respectively, so that the same can be implemented on the CMMS portal.**

12. The receipt of this circular may be acknowledged.

Narayanm 9/1/2026

(Mritunjay Kumar Narayan)
Registrar General & Census Commissioner of India

To

The Director of Census Operations (All States/UT)

Copy to:

1. All Divisional Heads including Language Division, Kolkata.
2. PS to Addl. RG(S/SK)/DDG.
3. Guard File.